

USB Ports

USB ports are important for all notebook users. Although you may initially feel that a couple of USB ports are more than enough a couple of days of use may change your opinion forever. There may be a case where a user may need to simultaneously connect four USB devices such as a USB mouse, printer, thumb drive and their PDA; this means that four USB ports would be required. We figure most regular users will need at least two ports; so given future expansion three ports would be just right.

Almost all notebooks come with memory card readers inbuilt; this is a real boon for anyone looking to hook up their memory cards directly to the notebook as it frees up one USB port. Users wanting to back up a lot of data fast may want to look at a faster alternative to USB; many notebooks come with FireWire ports and although rare, notebooks with E-SATA connects are also available.



Video Connectivity

A notebook will always have some form of video connectivity; depending on your usage this may not be a factor or it may influence the buying decision totally. A D-Sub port is usually de facto for connection to a larger monitor. With large screen LCDs monitors becoming common we figure DVI is one connect your notebook ought to have; this is because many of the newer LCD monitors do not have D-Sub connects at all. Either of these connects can also be used with a projector; useful for presentations. HDMI connectivity is also a huge plus since this allows direct connection with large LCD and plasma panels and is important if you wish your notebook to double as an HTPC.

